An Anglo-Indian soup from colonial days, mulligatawny has many variations. For extra heat, pop a split red chile in the pan when you add in the stock.

mulligatawny

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 45 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

2½ tbsp butter
1 large onion, chopped
2in (5cm) fresh ginger, finely chopped
2 garlic cloves, finely chopped
1 apple, diced with peel
1 carrot, sliced
1 celery rib, sliced
1 heaped tbsp mild curry powder
1 tbsp flour
4 tomatoes, coarsely chopped
2 tsp tomato purée
2 cups hot chicken stock
2 bay leaves
salt and freshly ground black pepper
¾ cup coconut milk or half-and-half
7oz (200g) cooked chicken meat, shredded
2 tbsp chopped fresh cilantro
juice of ½ lime

1 Melt the butter in a large pan and soften the onion, ginger, and garlic for 10 minutes, without coloring. Add the apple, carrot, and celery to the pan and continue cooking, covered, for 5 minutes.

2 Stir in the curry powder and cook for 1 minute, stirring all the time. Sprinkle in the flour and continue cooking for another 20 seconds.

3 Add the tomatoes and tomato purée followed by the chicken stock. Add the bay leaves and season with salt and pepper. Bring to a boil, stirring, then reduce the heat and simmer, half-covered, for 20 minutes.

4 Remove the bay leaf and blend until smooth, using a stick blender or liquidizer. Sieve the soup to remove any fibers and skin. Reheat, stir in the coconut milk or half-and-half, and add the diced chicken. Sharpen with a squeeze of lime and add the chopped cilantro.